

**SIMATS ENGINEERING
ASSESSMENT TOOL 2**

COURSE NAME: Theory of Computation **COURSE CODE:** CSA13

COURSE OUTCOME COVERED

CO1: Analyze fundamental mathematical concepts of automata theory for formal languages and decision problems (BL:3)

Simulation

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SIMATS ENGINEERING ASSESSMENT TOOL

Solutions

Question 1: NFA for Automatic Door System

Formal Definition (5- tuple): $N = (Q, \Sigma, \delta, q_0, F)$

- $Q = \{\text{Closed, Opening, Open, Closing}\}$
- $\Sigma = \{P, N\}$ (P = Person detected, N = No person detected)
- $q_0 = \text{Closed}$ (start state)
- $F = \{\text{Open}\}$ (accepting state — door successfully open)

Transition Table

State	P	N
$\rightarrow$ Closed	{Opening}	{Closed}
Opening	{Opening, Open}	{Open}
*Open	{Open}	{Open, Closing}
Closing	{Opening}	{Closing, Closed}

($\rightarrow$ = start state, * = final/accepting state)

Explanation of Non - determinism:

- From Opening on input P, the system may non -d eterministically stay in Opening (still moving) or advance to Open — modeling the uncertain duration of the door's opening motion.
- From Open on input N, the automaton may either remain in Open (grace period / sensor delay) or transition to Closing — this is the key non -d eterministic choice described in the problem.
- From Closing on input N, the system may stay Closing or complete the cycle back to Closed.

State Diagram (textual):

Closed — *P* → *Opening* — *P* → *Open* — *N* → *Closing* — *N* → *Closed*, with self-loops: *Closed* on *N*, *Opening* on *P* (self-loop, non-det.), *Open* on *P* (self-loop) and on *N* (self-loop, non-det.), *Closing* on *N* (self-loop, non-det.).

Question 2: Finite Automaton for Traffic Light Control System

Formal Definition: $M = (Q, \Sigma, \delta, q_0, F)$

- $Q = \{\text{Red, Green, Yellow}\}$
- $\Sigma = \{T\}$ (T = timer signal / timeout event that triggers the next transition)
- $q_0 = \text{Red}$ (start state)
- $F = Q$ (every state is a valid/accepting operating state — this is a cyclic controller, not a language acceptor)

Transition Table

State	Input T (timer expires)	Duration
→ Red	Green	30 sec
Green	Yellow	25 sec
Yellow	Red	5 sec

Cycle:

Red — *T* → *Green* — *T* → *Yellow* — *T* → *Red* — *T* → ... (repeats indefinitely; the automaton has no final halting state since traffic control runs continuously).

Handling continuous cycling:

Each state has an internal timer. Once the timer for a state expires, input symbol T is generated internally, forcing a deterministic transition to the next state in the fixed sequence. Because δ is a total function returning exactly one next state for T , the automaton is deterministic and cycles forever without ever reaching a dead or terminal condition.

Extension – Pedestrian Crossing:

Add a new state Pedestrian_Walk , reachable from Red on a pedestrian button input signal B: $\delta(\text{Red}, B) =$

Pedestrian_Walk. This state runs its own timer (walk time) and then returns to Red before the normal cycle

resumes: $\delta(\text{Pedestrian_Walk}, T) = \text{Red}$.

Extension – Emergency Vehicle Override:

Add an input symbol E (emergency signal) that can interrupt any state:

$\delta(\text{Green}, E) = \text{Red}$ and $\delta(\text{Yellow}, E) =$

Red. This forces the intersection to Red immediately regardless of the current timer, after which a dedicated

Emergency state can hold Red for all conflicting directions until E is withdrawn, then normal cycling resumes from Red.

Question 3: DFA Accepting Strings Ending with “ab” over {a, b}

Formal Definition: $M = (Q, \Sigma, \delta, q_0, F)$

- $Q = \{q_0, q_1, q_2\}$
- $\Sigma = \{a, b\}$
- q_0 = start state (no relevant suffix seen yet)
- $F = \{q_2\}$ (last two symbols read were “ab”)

Transition Table

State	a	b
$\rightarrow q_0$	q_1	q_0
q_1	q_1	q_2
$*q_2$	q_1	q_0

State meaning:

- q_0 — initial state / last symbol was not ‘a’
- q_1 — last symbol read was ‘a’ (potential start of “ab”)

- q_2 — accepting state; the last two symbols read were exactly “ab”

Trace for $W = aaabab$:

Step	Input	Current State	Next State
1	a	q_0	q_1
2	a	q_1	q_1
3	a	q_1	q_1
4	b	q_1	q_2
5	a	q_2	q_1
6	b	q_1	q_2

Result: Final state reached = $q_2 \in F \rightarrow$ the string “aaabab” is ACCEPTED (it ends with “ab”).

Question 4: DFA Accepting Exactly {“c”, “bc”, “bcaaa”} over {a, b, c}

Formal Definition: $M = (Q, \Sigma, \delta, q_0, F)$

- $Q = \{q_0, q_1, q_2, q_3, q_4, q_5, q_6, q_d\}$
- $\Sigma = \{a, b, c\}$
- q_0 = start state
- $F = \{q_1, q_3, q_6\}$ (accept exactly “c”, “bc”, “bcaaa” respectively)
- q_d = dead/trap state for any string that deviates from the three valid patterns

Transition Table

State	a	b	c	Meaning
$\rightarrow q_0$	q_d	q_2	q_1	start
$*q_1$	q_d	q_d	q_d	accepts “c”
q_2	q_d	q_d	q_3	read ‘b’
$*q_3$	q_4	q_d	q_d	accepts “bc”
q_4	q_5	q_d	q_d	read “bca”
q_5	q_6	q_d	q_d	read “bcaa”
$*q_6$	q_d	q_d	q_d	accepts “bcaaa”
q_d	q_d	q_d	q_d	dead state (trap)

Explanation:

- $q_0 \xrightarrow{c} q_1$ accepts the exact string “c”; any symbol after reaching q_1 sends the automaton to q_d since a longer string is no longer equal to “c”.
- $q_0 \xrightarrow{b} q_2 \xrightarrow{c} q_3$ accepts the exact string “bc”.
- $q_3 \xrightarrow{a} q_4 \xrightarrow{a} q_5 \xrightarrow{a} q_6$ accepts the exact string “bcaaa” (exactly three a’s after “bc”, no more, no less).

- Every other symbol combination (wrong branch, extra symbols, or premature stop that isn't q1/q3/q6) leads to qd, which loops on all inputs and is never accepting — guaranteeing only the three target strings are accepted.

Question 5: DFA Accepting All Strings Starting with 'a' or 'b' over {a, b}

Formal Definition: $M = (Q, \Sigma, \delta, q_0, F)$

- $Q = \{q_0, q_1\}$
- $\Sigma = \{a, b\}$
- q_0 = start state (nothing read yet)
- $F = \{q_1\}$ (at least one symbol has been read)

Transition Table

State	a	b
$\rightarrow q_0$	q1	q1
*q1	q1	q1

Explanation:

Since $\Sigma = \{a, b\}$, every non-empty string necessarily begins with either 'a' or 'b'. As soon as the first symbol is read, the DFA moves from q_0 to the accepting state q_1 and remains there (self-loop on both a and b) for the rest of the string, regardless of what follows. The empty string leaves the automaton in q_0 , which is non-accepting, so it is correctly rejected.

Note on the dead state: A separate trap state is not strictly required here because both symbols from both states

lead to a valid accepting state; if the simulator (e.g., Autosim) requires δ to be fully defined and a designated fail case for malformed/non-alphabet input, an additional qd state can be added such that $\delta(q_0, x) = q_d$ and $\delta(q_1, x) = q_d$ for any $x \notin \{a, b\}$.